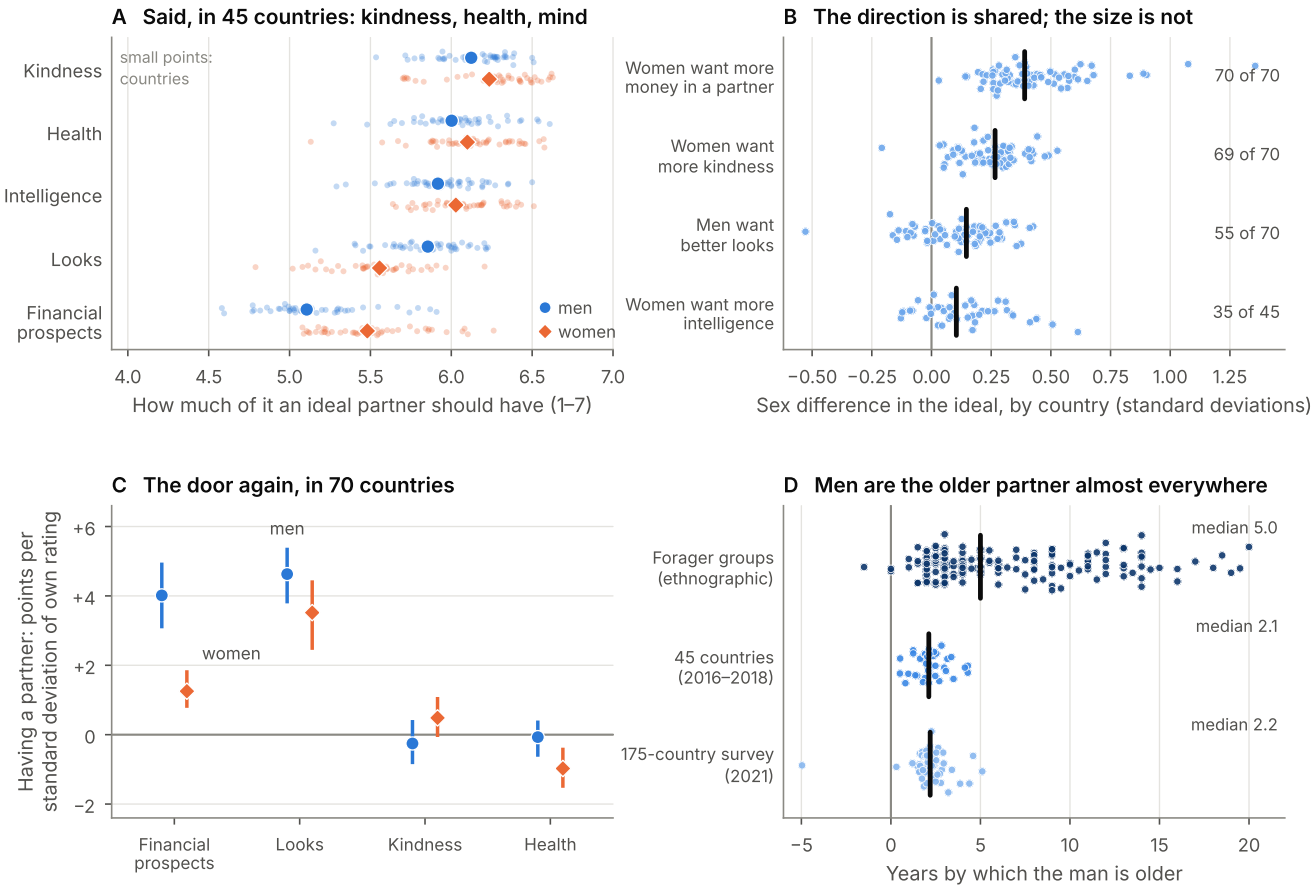
A Said, in 45 countries: kindness, health, mind
small points: countries
Kindness
Health
Intelligence
Looks
Financial prospects
men
women
4.0
4.5
5.0
5.5
6.0
6.5
7.0
How much of it an ideal partner should have (1–7)
B The direction is shared; the size is not
Women want more money in a partner
Women want more kindness
Men want better looks
Women want more intelligence
70 of 70
69 of 70
55 of 70
35 of 45
−0.50
−0.25
0.00
0.25
0.50
0.75
1.00
1.25
Sex difference in the ideal, by country (standard deviations)
C The door again, in 70 countries
Having a partner: points per standard deviation of own rating
+6
+4
+2
0
−2
men
women
Financial prospects
Looks
Kindness
Health
D Men are the older partner almost everywhere
Forager groups (ethnographic)
45 countries (2016–2018)
175-country survey (2021)
median 5.0
median 2.1
median 2.2
−5
0
5
10
15
20
Years by which the man is older